

Singapore Permanent Residence (PR) Application Policy

This document provides an overview of the eligibility criteria, application requirements, National Service obligations, required documentation, applicable fees, processing timelines, and completion procedures for individuals applying for Singapore Permanent Residence (PR). It is intended to help applicants understand the application process and their responsibilities before submitting an application.

Eligibility

Foreign nationals may apply for Singapore Permanent Residence under one of the following categories, subject to the applicable eligibility requirements.

Applicants who are the **spouse of a Singapore Citizen or Singapore Permanent Resident (PR)** must have their application sponsored by their spouse. The sponsoring spouse is required to submit the application through the ICA e-Service using their Singpass account.

An **unmarried child below the age of 21 years**, who was either born within a legal marriage or legally adopted by a Singapore Citizen or PR, may apply for PR through sponsorship by their parent. The sponsoring parent must submit the application using their Singpass account.

The **aged parent of a Singapore Citizen** who is at least 21 years old may also apply for PR. The Singapore Citizen child will act as the sponsor and submit the application through ICA e-Service using Singpass.

Applicants who currently hold a valid **Employment Pass (EP)** or **S Pass** may submit their own application by logging into the ICA e-Service using their Singpass credentials.

Students studying in Singapore who have passed at least one national examination, including the **PSLE, GCE N-Level, O-Level, or A-Level**, or who are enrolled in the **Integrated Programme (IP)**, may also be eligible. Applicants aged 15 years and above must submit their applications using Singpass, while applicants below 15 years of age may use the non-Singpass application option provided by ICA.

Foreign investors may apply through the **Global Investor Programme (GIP)** administered by the Singapore Economic Development Board (EDB), subject to the programme's eligibility and assessment requirements.

When assessing applications, the Immigration and Checkpoints Authority (ICA) considers several factors including family ties to Singapore, economic contributions, educational qualifications, age, family profile, duration of residence, and the applicant's ability to integrate into Singapore society and demonstrate a long-term commitment to the country.

Permanent Residents are permitted to reside in Singapore indefinitely. Individuals aged 15 years and above will be issued a Singapore Blue Identity Card (IC). PR holders intending to travel overseas must maintain a valid Re-Entry Permit to preserve their permanent residence status.

Applicants should note that ICA does not endorse or work with any external immigration consultancy or migration agency claiming to guarantee or influence PR application outcomes.

Singpass Requirement

All applicants included in a Permanent Residence application are required to review and acknowledge the submitted application before final submission.

Eligible applicants must log into the ICA e-Service using their Singpass account. Individuals who are not eligible for Singpass will receive alternative login credentials issued by ICA for the purpose of completing the required declarations.

As Singpass registration may require approximately two to five working days for approval, applicants and sponsors are advised to obtain active Singpass accounts before initiating the application process.

National Service Obligation

Under the Enlistment Act 1970, all male Singapore Citizens and Permanent Residents, unless officially exempted, are required to perform National Service (NS).

After completing full-time National Service, individuals become Operationally Ready National Servicemen (NSmen). The NS obligation generally continues until the age of 50 years for commissioned officers and 40 years for other ranks.

Male applicants who obtain Singapore Citizenship or Permanent Residence as foreign students or under parental sponsorship are liable for National Service. Registration for NS is required upon reaching the age of sixteen and a half years, with enlistment generally commencing at eighteen years of age or upon completion of approved pre-university education, whichever is later.

The Ministry of Defence permits deferment only until the completion of approved pre-tertiary education such as GCE A-Level or Polytechnic Diploma. Deferment is not granted for university education. Applicants who obtain PR or Citizenship during university studies may be required to interrupt their studies to fulfil National Service obligations.

Male Singapore Citizens who have not fulfilled their National Service obligations may be prevented from renouncing their citizenship.

Failure to fulfil National Service obligations constitutes an offence under the Enlistment Act 1970 and may result in fines, imprisonment, or both, as prescribed by law.

Renouncing or losing Permanent Residence without completing full-time National Service may negatively affect future applications to work, study, or obtain long-term immigration facilities in Singapore. Such actions may also adversely affect immigration-related applications submitted by immediate family members.

Documents Required

Applicants must submit all required supporting documents listed in the official ICA document checklist applicable to their eligibility category. The submission of complete and accurate documentation is essential for timely processing of the Permanent Residence application.

All original documents must be produced upon request by the Immigration and Checkpoints Authority (ICA). Documents issued in languages other than English must be accompanied by an official English translation prepared by an authorised translator or the relevant issuing authority.

Depending on the applicant's eligibility category, the following documents may be required:

- A valid passport and travel document.
- Birth certificate and identification documents.
- Marriage certificate, divorce certificate, or adoption documents (where applicable).
- Singapore Identity Card (NRIC) or Permanent Resident Identity Card of the sponsor, where sponsorship is required.
- Employment Pass (EP), S Pass, or other valid immigration pass.
- Employment letter, recent salary slips, and employer's declaration for employed applicants.
- Educational certificates, academic transcripts, and professional qualifications.
- Recent passport-sized photograph meeting ICA specifications.
- Income Tax Notices of Assessment and CPF contribution statements, where applicable.
- Business registration documents and financial statements for business owners or investors.
- Student pass, school transcripts, and examination results for student applicants.
- Proof of residential address and any additional supporting documents requested by ICA.

Applicants are responsible for ensuring that all submitted documents are accurate, complete, and up to date. Any false declaration, omission of material information, or submission of forged or altered documents may result in the rejection of the application or other legal consequences under Singapore law.

Incomplete applications or missing supporting documents may delay the assessment process, require additional verification, or lead to the application being returned or rejected. Applicants may be requested to submit further documents during the assessment period if deemed necessary by ICA.

Applicants are advised to retain copies of all submitted documents for their personal records. Submission of supporting documents does not guarantee approval, as each application is assessed individually based on ICA's prevailing policies and eligibility criteria.

Application Fees

Applicants are required to pay an application fee of **S\$100** at the time of submission. This fee is non-refundable regardless of the outcome of the application.

Upon successful approval and completion of formalities, additional fees are payable, including:

- Entry Permit – **S\$20**
- Five-Year Re-Entry Permit – **S\$50**
- Singapore Identity Card – **S\$50**

Payments may be made online using Visa, MasterCard, American Express (AMEX), Internet Direct Debit through participating Singapore banks, or PayNow. Applicants may also be notified of any additional applicable fees where necessary.

Processing Time

Permanent Residence applications are generally processed within **six months**, provided that all required documents have been submitted correctly and no additional information is required.

Certain applications may require a longer assessment period depending on their complexity or the need for further verification.

Applicants will receive the outcome of their application via email or other official notification methods. The application status may also be monitored online through MyICA or the ICA e-Service.

Completion of Formalities

Applicants whose Permanent Residence applications are approved will receive an **In-Principle Approval (IPA)** notification.

Permanent Residence status will only be granted after the applicant has fulfilled all required conditions, completed the necessary formalities, submitted the requested documents, and paid all applicable fees within the specified timeframe.

Failure to complete the required formalities before the stipulated deadline may result in the approval being withdrawn.